

Looks Blocks

Learning Objectives

- Use Looks blocks to change sprite appearance
- Switch costumes and backdrops programmatically
- Apply size and visibility effects to sprites

Engage (5-7 minutes)

During a yakshagana performance, dancers wear different masks and costumes to change their character. Looks blocks let your sprite do the same—change its costume, size, or even hide completely. Today we give our sprites the power of disguise.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Click on the Looks category in Scratch. Try “say Hello” and see a speech bubble appear. Use “switch costume” to change how your sprite looks. Add multiple costumes to your sprite and cycle through them. Try “change size by 25” and watch your sprite grow.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Looks blocks control the visual appearance of sprites. “Say” creates speech or thought bubbles, “switch costume” changes the sprite’s image, and “change size” makes it bigger or smaller. You can also show or hide sprites and switch backdrops to change the scene.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Create a story where your sprite changes costumes to show different emotions—happy, sad, surprised. Use “switch backdrop” to change from a village morning scene to evening. Make a sprite appear, grow larger, say something, and then hide. Think of it like a magic show.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Name three things Looks blocks can change. If you want your sprite to tell a joke with a speech bubble, which block would you use? Describe a project that uses at least two different Looks blocks.